

Felix Dukes

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TECHNICAL WRITER/EDITOR

Technical Writer/Editor with 20+ years of experience guiding documentation in all aspects of a project's life cycle. I drive recommendations on documentation design and develop work plans by interfacing with various teams and roles to execute and manage an array of technical documents from API specs to BI Analytics documentation. I have in-depth experience with Agile and Waterfall development life cycles and with structured authoring using DITA XML (XMetaL and easyDITA) and Component Content Management System (CCMS) tools. I thrive in a collaborative environment, building relationships with peers and SMEs, and am always interested in improving quality, efficiency, and measurable objectives.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Technical Writer

Verisys Corporation – Louisville, KY

June 2020 – July 2026

Responsible for developing RESTful API documentation for client integration with our credentialing and compliance systems for healthcare providers and networks. After integration, clients transmit and retrieve verification and validation information as part of the healthcare credentialing process.

Additionally, I wrote and maintained end-user reference materials including implementation guides, reference guides, FAQs, and more for internal and external audiences. As part of deliverable maintenance, I worked closely with developers and project managers to track all revisions and managed the Enterprise Change Management process to improve reporting accuracy and provide better insight into our deployment metrics.

Technical Communications Specialist

Data Systems International – Kansas City, MO

June 2017 – March 2020

Responsible for writing business intelligence analytics documentation for the DSI Analytics Insights documentation suite. The documentation suite included implementation guides, configuration guides, user guides, and system architecture illustrations. All deliverables were created using DITA XML structured authoring. My responsibilities included working closely with system developers and upper management to identify business objectives and authoring, editing, and managing documentation plans and deliverables published to the customer documentation portal. Additionally, I authored client-facing web services (API) documentation for their flagship Cloud Inventory system. Authoring at DSI required building relationships across multiple roles within product development. As a researcher, I often delved into system administration to identify configuration elements and parameters, providing clients with context and functional impact. This experience proved valuable and helped me analyze and better target our audience. To prepare for publication, I worked directly with our localization vendor to manage, confirm, and compile text strings for translation to various languages. I was responsible for creating corporate standards and best practices for all writers within the organization to improve consistency.

Senior Technical Writer/Editor

Garmin International – Olathe, KS

June 2016 – June 2017

Responsible for writing consumer product documentation for automotive, marine, and outdoor business segments. Authored, edited, and managed documentation plans to deliver Important Product Safety Information, Owner's Manuals (print and on-device help format), and Quick Start Manuals using DITA XML outputs. Collaborated closely with project managers and subject matter experts to deliver thorough, accurate user documentation based on Garmin engineering practices throughout the project life cycle. As a member of several project teams, I worked directly with project managers, engineers (mechanical and software), and translation specialists. At Garmin, all authors adhered to established standards, enabling us to leverage content-reuse strategies that saved time and translation costs.

Lead Technical Writer/Technical Communications Specialist

DST Systems, Inc. – Kansas City, MO

January 2006 – June 2016

Responsible for writing new and maintaining existing client-facing software documentation for the Retirement Solutions product suite. Authored, designed, edited, managed, and published help systems, manuals (Installation and Configuration, User, Product, Process, and Training guides), release notes, and WIKI content using the following methods:

- Authoring content using CCMS and DITA XML with sound structure.
- Adhering to established standards and best practices.
- Leveraging content reuse to increase efficiency and consistency across multiple deliverables.
- Working with UX associates to standardize system error messaging across the product suite.
- Advising the scrum team regarding actionable interface elements and providing contextual content when needed.
- Ensuring project support and alignment with internal communications plans, branding, and communications standards.
- Contributing to the evaluation of XMetaL and oXygen before selecting our DITA XML authoring tool.
- Auditing and cataloging existing materials and processes.
- Working with the Technology Leadership Committee to develop agendas and document next steps.
- Contributing to the development of writing standards and processes.

Senior Technical Writer/Editor

DST Systems, Inc. – Kansas City, MO

April 2003 – December 2005

Wrote new and existing technical documentation, which included version-based publications, online help, webpages, and more.

- Developing and documenting new documentation standards as part of a corporate rebrand initiative.
- Maintaining and packaging a master help system linked to sub-help systems, all accessible to clients through an HTML page.
- Assisting with documentation as a component of larger projects run by senior staff.
- Mentoring and assisting junior writers, as needed.

Staff Technical Writer/Editor

DST Systems, Inc. – Kansas City, MO

November 2000 – March 2003

Updated existing and legacy documentation after application or business changes occurred. Actively participated in teams focused on client initiatives.

- Revising and updating online help systems using RoboHelp.
- Contributing to website design and content management using Dreamweaver (HTML, CSS).
- Maintaining MS Word-based documentation suite.

Technical Writer/Editor

DST Systems, Inc. – Kansas City, MO

April 1999 – October 2000

Primarily responsible for editing documents authored by business analysts before publication to our client repository.

- Following established workflows to verify documentation accuracy and approval for publication.
- Packaging and coordinating documents with the print vendor to meet a weekly deadline.
- Collaborating with business analysts and project leads to ensure the accuracy of edited content. This required building relationships and trust with dozens of subject matter experts.
- Maintaining the legacy documentation database for archival purposes.

TOOLS

- Vasant (CCMS) – Four Years
- SDL (CCMS) – One Year
- Jorsek easyDITA – Three Years
- XMetaL – DITA XML Editor – Eight Years
- Adobe Technical Communications Suite – 25 Years
 - Acrobat
 - RoboHelp HTML Help
 - InDesign
 - Captivate
- Microsoft Office Suite – 25 Years
- Microsoft Visio – 25 Years
- Draw.io – Six Years
- TechSmith Snagit – 14 Years
- Balsamiq Mockups – Two Years
- Cubase Pro (for adding audio narration to interactive PDFs) – 10 Years
- Atlassian (Confluence , JIRA) – 10 Years

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), University of Missouri – Kansas City, May 1996 - Literature and Music

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Presented at the 52nd Annual Society for Technical Communication (STC) Conference
Seattle, Washington

Co-authored and Presented: **Using Downtime Effectively as the Deadline Approaches**

References Available Upon Request